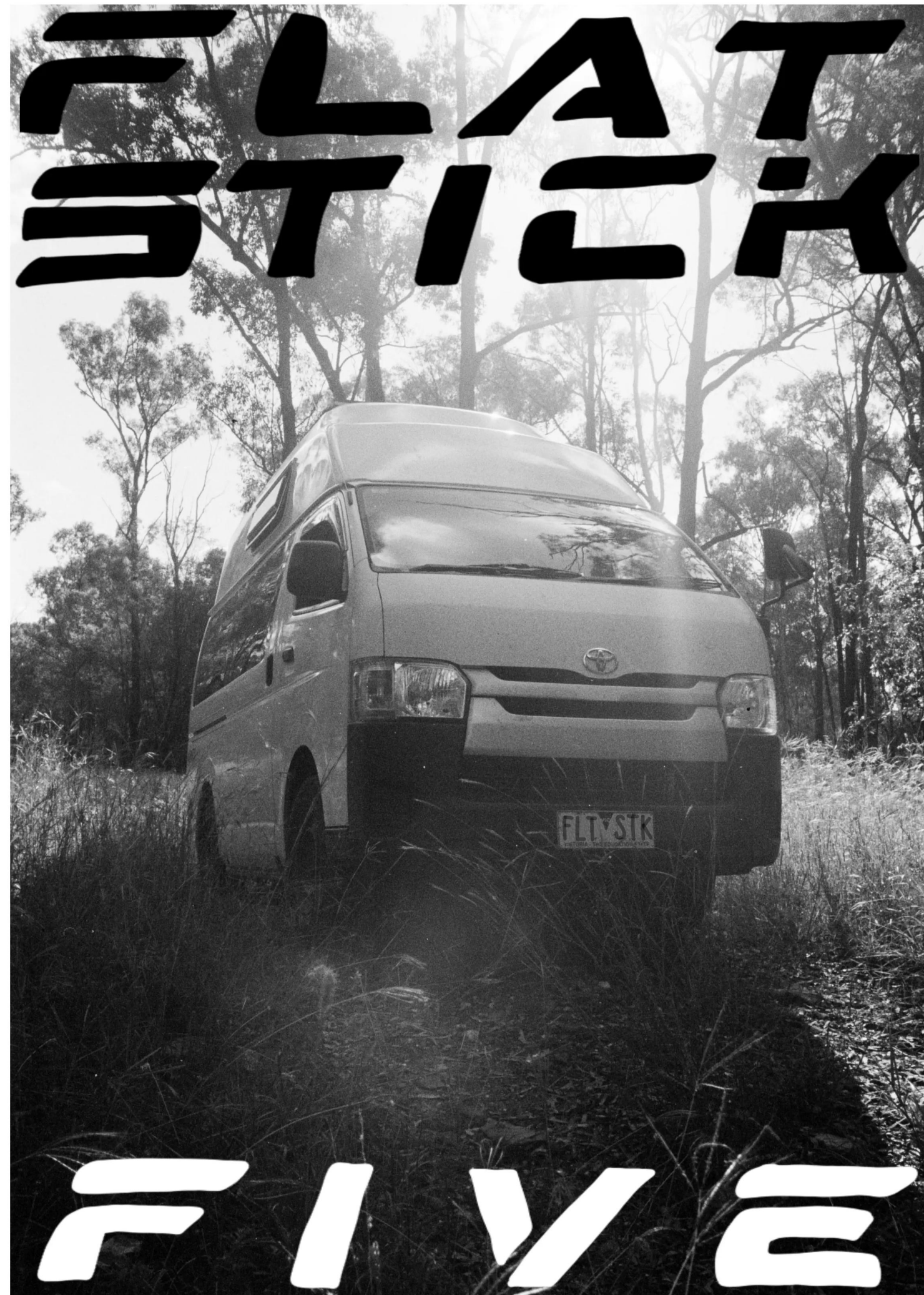
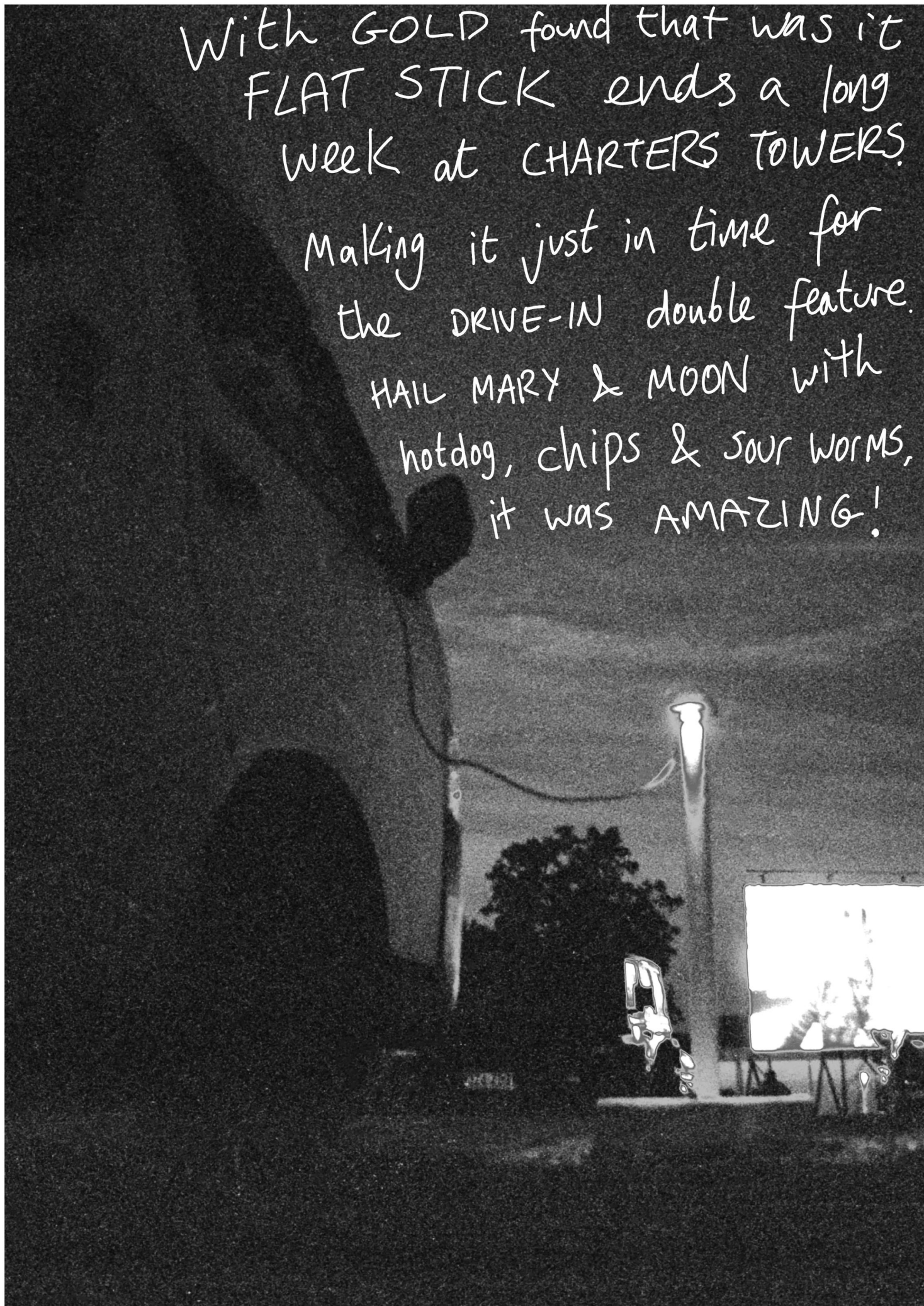


With GOLD found that was it
FLAT STICK ends a long
week at CHARTERS TOWERS.
Making it just in time for
the DRIVE-IN double feature.
HAIL MARY & MOON with
hotdog, chips & sour worms,
it was AMAZING!



/50

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FLAT STICK is a zine documenting
my trip around Australia. All
photos are mine, taken on 35mm
film & developed in the Van.
zines are printed in the great
public Libraries of Australia

To follow along with the journey &
see other zines please visit:

FLATSTICKZINE.GITHUB.IO

EUREKA





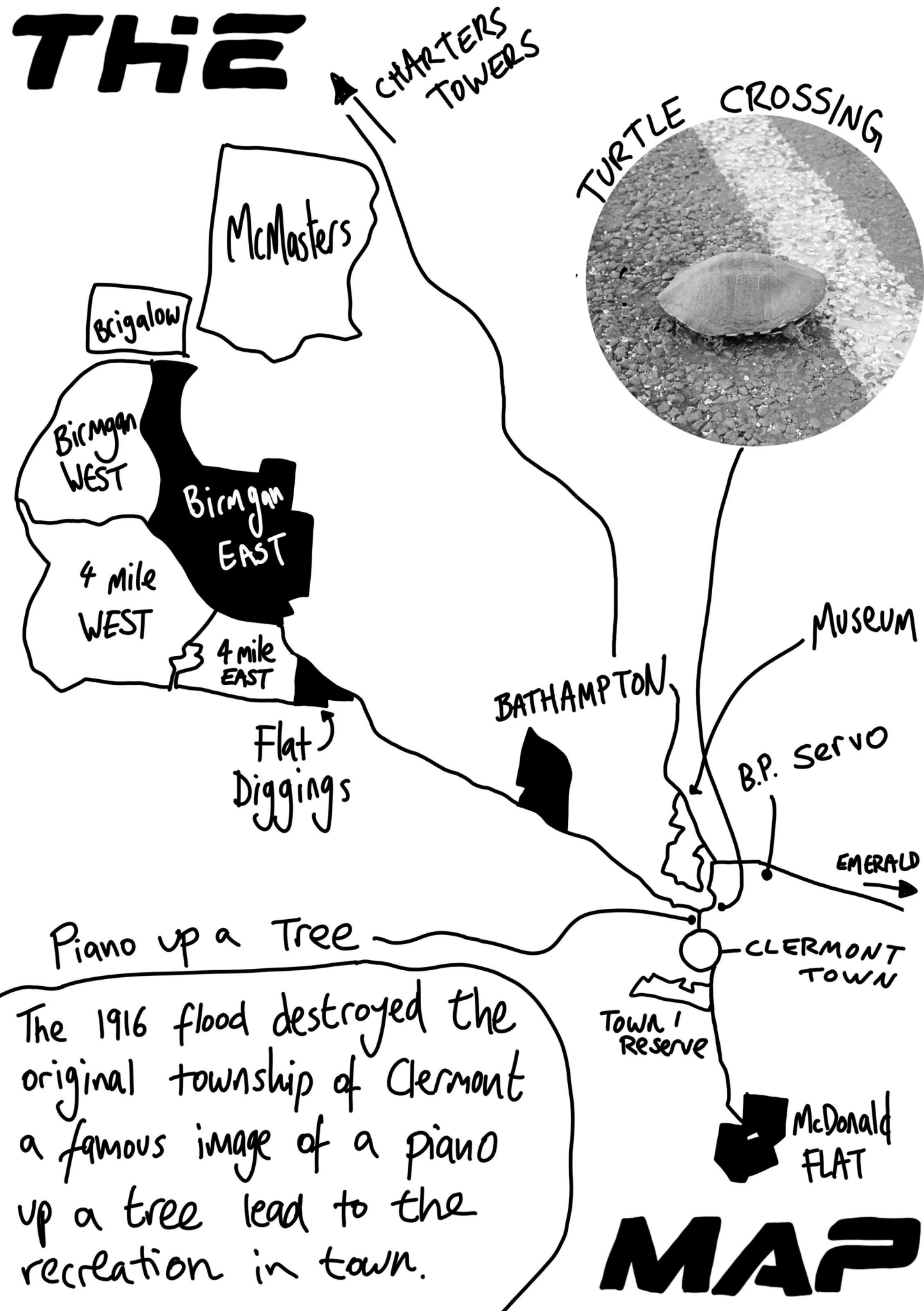
I had all but given up but I decided I'll have one more day, one search at the 3rd spot, my body stiff from the day before I made it in a little nervous. The ground was quartz white, an alluvial gold site, finding a rich ancient creek bed the old timers had dug up this spot extensively. I spent a few hours swinging until on a steep bank I hit a target, as I slowly narrowed it down I was left with a rock I turned it over & there it was

Welcome,

I made it to Clermont, it has 12 "GPA"s where you can go fossicking, for only \$10. It has a rich gold & copper mining history. I was eager to find gold & got stuck in. Pushing the limits of my van & myself hoping it all paid off in the end.

love Jared ^{xx}

THE



The 1916 flood destroyed the original township of Clermont a famous image of a piano up a tree lead to the recreation in town.

MAP

FREEDOM



After ~6hrs of trying I made it free, the only problem was I made it out west but the way out was EAST back through the mud, the track ahead had collapsed, there was an unmarked track but it was getting dark & I was exhausted, covered in mud, my hands were cut up. I used the last of my water to have a shower & slept like a baby. Luckily the other track led me out.





BOGGED



After trying for a while with sticks under each wheel it became clear I needed to alleviate the grounding at the front & rear. Using the JACK I managed to raise each wheel & place logs under each raising the height & degrounding the van. It was slow muddy work bit by bit. I wasn't sure if anyone would come so I kept at it.

BATHAMPTON



I was feeling good & made my way into Bathampton spending a day searching at the first two sites, more junk but I met another fossicker he said he was right at the back & has found a few nuggets. I decided to head in deeper, the tracks were 4WD but the van was going well. The next morning I headed into right to the back this is the has got to be it less people would have been back here. There was a spot of deep wheel ruts filled with mud I aimed offset like the pic & about halfway through the whole van slid sideways into the mud!



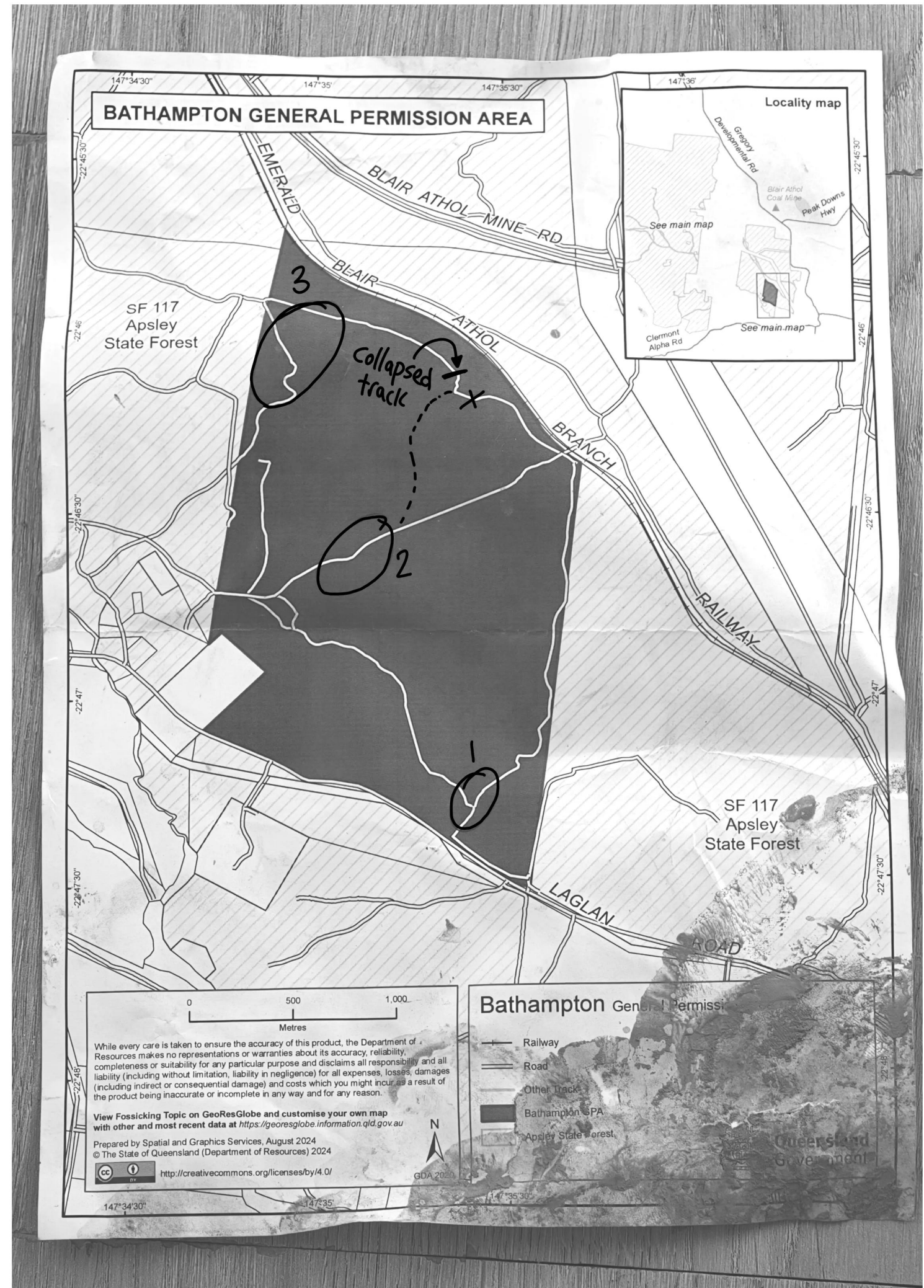
GAME PLAN

The plan was to stay at the B.P. servo out of town at sunrise head in & detect all day, then back to B.P. at night. First day I checked out FLAT DIGGINS one of the newest spots open. I found some old metal & walked into a lot of spiders webs. That night I did more research & decided McDonalds Flat might be a better bet with lots of old mines there. Funnily one of the spots was called BATHAMPTON an area in the UK near BATH, where my brother lived & I did for a while on my narrowboat. I spent all day at McDonalds Flat to no avail lots of junk, old jean rivets, cans, nails but no gold. I decided I've got to go deeper, on a dirt road I headed up to an old mine called

A common site in fossicking areas, can in a tree, off the ground so you don't end up detecting the metal can. →



RIP & TEAR, its amazing how decades & even centuries later the land remains scarred from the old-timers. oil barrels, barbed wire, even old cars remain behind, almost always lots of alcohol bottles. The days had been long & no finds yet, if it was easy everyone would be doing it especially with the current GOLD price.



TIP OFF

I headed into town to the prospecting store, there's a bit of a buzz because there is a new detector out & every one wants their hands on it. I asked the owner about any tips & told him where I had been. He said "Oh you're the guy in the BONGO Van, the mining lease holder of McDonalds Flats wasn't happy." Turns out the public fossicking area at McDonalds Flat has been pegged for mining lease & out of bounds! Not off to a good start, I had no idea. He pulled out a map (see right) & said there is GOLD here, here & here. I thanked him profusely ran out & circled the spots he told me.



